



Imaging Pratip Ingale

A LINUX For Everyone

We test latest Linux distros to find the ideal candidates for SoHo use

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Not too long ago, Linux was predominantly considered as an operating system for geeks and the idea of installing it on a home desktop was totally alien. Though fervently used on servers, on the desktop side, system administrators were the only humans to accept Linux open-heartedly.

Despite being free to use, Linux never really caught on big time, for, it had grisly hardware compatibility issues, a rustic GUI in comparison to Windows and Macintosh—a command line interface that asked you to

remember thousands of commands and in case you got stuck, and there was no one who could help you out.

However, as with many things, Linux also has undergone a gradual evolution. Most teething problems have been well taken care of. Hardware detection has improved by leaps and bounds and provides better control over your hardware.

The graphical interface has replaced many command line utilities and hence, working with Linux is much simpler today. In case you get stuck, there is a strong community eager to solve your problems, and companies that offer dedicated support.

All these things have helped Linux to elevate its perception from a not so user-friendly OS to a must-try operating system.

Though Linux has evolved into a user-friendly OS, in no way has the taming come at the expense of the stability or flexibility that's inherent to it. This domesticated beast is still potent enough to be deployed on a server and lithe enough to be used on a desktop. This single attribute makes Linux a one-size-fits-all solution and gives it a leg up in comparison to its competitors.

Architecturally, Linux is quite different from Windows, right from its philosophy to the final implementation. It is modular, which makes it powerful, but